

anti-hegemony clause, we must persistently be sure that the clause is confined to a general principle. We will preserve defense strength that is based on civilian control, aimed at defense only and maintained at its current scale. As a complement to that, we will immediately evaluate the function of the Japan-U.S. Security Treaty. We will work to form national consensus towards defense by, among other things, establishing a defense committee in the Diet.

NEW LIBERAL CLUB (NLC)
KONO, REPRESENTATIVE

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1. Political Discipline

It is impossible to prevent corruption as long as politicians and political parties do not deal with the politics by holding strict ethical views. It is important that all dietmen have the determination to reexamine and reform themselves. In the meantime, we will call for an investigation regarding the way elections should be run. We will expand the public management of elections and investigate ways that part of the political party activity funds can be borne by the national treasury. Moreover, without the trust of the public towards politics, no matter how good the policy, it is not possible to advance legislation smoothly. In order to maintain and develop a liberal society, the birth of a new conservative party was necessary. We seek the active participation of the public and aim for lucid, easy to understand politics.

2. Electoral System

We will expand even further the public management of elections. We will, after deciding on a fixed standard, investigate a system that will automatically make corrections in imbalances in the representation of election districts. In this case, the total number of seats will not be changed. We must promote reform of the election system so that it better reflects the public will, but we strongly oppose adoption of a system, such as the current small election districts plan, that is based on benefiting one party. With regard to Upper House elections, we must move towards a drastic reform. But for the present, with regard to the method of electing representatives from the national constituency, we must carry out an immediate revision in time for the next Upper House election. We propose for the national constituency the system of proportional representation using restricted lists of names.

3. Domestic Affairs

The future of the nation will depend in a wide sense on the fruits of education, and thus we will make education policy the top priority of the government. We will seek the opinions of people from various fields and then propose reforms regarding the current 6-3 system that advances almost 100 percent of the students to the high school level. In addition we will investigate the unification of the various pension systems, which have different fees and give different benefits. We will immediately

raise the old age pensions for couples from 27 thousand yen to 50 thousand yen.

In order to deal with the economy and decreases in real income, we will propose to carry out income tax cuts of one trillion yen this year and one trillion yen next year. We propose a comprehensive policy for the housing problem in order to build homes for three generation families. In addition, we will promote the building of cities and the nation of natural harmony and free of pollution. For agriculture, we will have the national treasury pay the entire amount for the undertaking to improve land. We will establish a small and medium sized businesses ministry to deal with the problems of small and medium sized businesses.

4. Diplomacy and Defense

To develop a wide-ranging peace diplomacy with the nations of the world and in order to maintain long-term and stable supplies of energy, natural resources, and food -- which are the most important parts of our national security -- we will deepen our mutually interdependent economic, industrial, educational, cultural, and other ties with Southeast Asia, the Pacific countries, and the Middle East. With regard to the problem of the Japan-China peace treaty, we believe that a road to a settlement will naturally open up if we work with sincerity to establish a relationship of trust between governments.

Hegemony, of course, is opposed not just by Japan and China

but by all. With regard to defense, we positively evaluate the "Basic Defense Plan" and propose that we fulfill it based on quality rather than quantity.